

THE INFLUENCE OF MUSIC GENRE ON RISK- TAKING BEHAVIOR AMONG YOUNG ADULT MALES: A QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that this thesis titled, "THE INFLUENCE OF MUSIC GENRE ON RISK- TAKING BEHAVIOR AMONG YOUNG ADULT MALES: A QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS" is a bonafide research work carried out by
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under our guidance and supervision at Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), Dubai for the requirement of the course MAP221- Dissertation in partial requirement of the Degree of Master of Science in Applied Psychology (Specialization: Clinical and Counselling Psychology)

The results presented in this dissertation have not previously formed the basis for the reward of any degree or fellowship.

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Declaration

I confirm that this thesis presented for the requirements of the course titled MAP221-Dissertation within the program Masters of Science in Applied Psychology (with a specialization in Clinical and Counselling Psychology) has:

i. been composed entirely by myself,

ii. been solely the result of my own work, except where it states otherwise by reference or acknowledgment,

iii. not been submitted for any other degree or professional qualification

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Introduction

Tones arranged in time and within a specific timeframe formed a type of art known as music. This form of art consisted of various components that brought in emotions and ideas while also conveying meanings, whether in the form of vocal or instrumental sounds and tones in a specific harmony, rhythm, and dynamics. For a long time, music had been used to tell stories, lores, dialogues, perform rituals, entertain people, and express emotions and feelings worldwide, showcasing diversity in human experience and culture through its various genres and being part of traditions and religions globally.

Historically, it was discovered that in addition to helping convey stories and emotions, music also profoundly influenced behavior, emotions, and cognition in humans. Among these influences, the impact of music specifically on young adult males, who were largely known to be highly connected and engaged with music, was quite fascinating. Due to the diverse traits that both music and human psychology were composed of, assessing the impact music had on a person's behavior was quite challenging. A broad range of feelings and emotions, from enthusiasm and happiness to hostility and grief, which in turn had been shown to alter thought processes and behavioral inclinations, was generated through music determined by its lyrics, melody, and rhythm (Juslin & Sloboda, 2001; Rentfrow & Gosling, 2003). Due to this, various studies were conducted to understand the degree of impact music had on the various components of human behavior.

A very important cohort that helped to understand how music affected an individual's behavior were young adult males. This group was well known for their affinity towards taking risks, largely because of their developmental stage and how easily they were influenced by external stimuli while also being highly interested and connected to music (Arnett, 1992). Individuals belonging to this age group used music as a form of recreation, socializing, self-expression, and inspiration. Moreover, it was occasionally seen that males in this developmental group were attracted to certain music genres such as rap, rock, hip-hop, and electronic dance music (EDM), which had commonly been associated with themes of rebellion, gratification, and debauchery (Frith, 1996; Rentfrow & Gosling, 2003).

An individual's inclination towards a particular music type over others was referred to as that individual's music preference (Hargreaves et al., 2012). These preferences were influenced by the pitch, tempo, dynamics, and rhythm of that particular music piece (Schäfer et al., 2009). According to the categorization used in STOMP developed by Rentfrow and Gosling, there were 16 genres of music categorized into four dimensions: Reflective & Complex dimension, which encompassed Classical, Blues, Jazz, and Folk music; Edgy & Aggressive dimension, which encompassed Alternative, Rock, and Heavy Metal music; Fun & Simple dimension, which encompassed Pop, Religious, Soundtrack, and Country music; and Energetic & Upbeat dimension, which encompassed Hip-Hop, Rap, Funk, Soul, and Electronic music. According to the updated categorization used in STOMP-R, there were 23 genres of music categorized into five dimensions: the Mellow dimension, which encompassed Electronica/Dance, New Age, and World Music; the Unpretentious dimension, which encompassed Pop, Country, and Religious music; the Sophisticated dimension, which encompassed Blues, Jazz, Bluegrass, Folk, Classical, Opera, and Gospel music; the Intense dimension, which encompassed Rock, Punk, Alternative, and Heavy Metal music; and the Contemporary dimension, which encompassed Rap, Soul/R&B, Funk, and Reggae music (Rentfrow & Gosling, 2003).

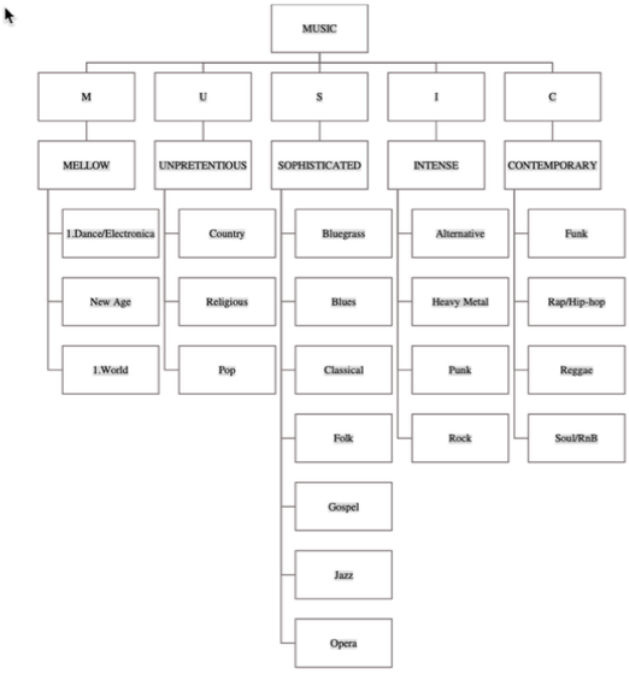


Fig.1. Grouping Music genres into 5 dimensions according to Rentfrow and Gosling

Brain studies on music inclination suggested the mental components underlying the wide range of musical preferences among social groupings. People worldwide heard music daily. It affected people in various ways, from guiding emotions to psychological developments to providing a means of self-expression. While practicing music was thought to enhance academic performance and turnout, no correlation was discovered between it and affective guidelines. Numerous analyses suggested that a single character could influence musical preferences, usually through the use of character; nevertheless, a meta-analysis in progress had shown that character explained very little variation in musical preferences.

Very often, particular music genres were associated with risky conduct like drug misuse, violence, and unsafe sexual practices based on anecdotal evidence and public discussion. However, there was a dearth of actual studies on this subject. Among the studies that had already been conducted, there were mixed findings. Some studies exhibited that interest in a particular music genre did indeed influence risk-taking behaviors in young adults, while some others showed that there was no influence between the two. There were also results from other studies that showed risk-taking behaviors were based on personality traits, which influenced interest in music genres.

Taking into account the above-stated aspects, this study aimed to investigate the following major questions:

a. What connection existed between young adult males' involvement in risky conduct and their exposure to various musical genres?

b. In what ways could individual variances in musical tastes and character attributes mitigate the impact of musical genres on risk-taking behavior?

c. How much did the association between risky conduct and music genre become mediated by cognitive functions like impulse control and decision-making?

For millennia, music had been an integral part of human society, fulfilling a variety of purposes from religious rites to social connection and emotional expression (Cross, 2001). Research had repeatedly shown that music had the emotional capacity to elicit a broad spectrum of affective experiences (Juslin & Sloboda, 2001). For example, music psychology

research had shown that slow tempo and delicate dynamics tended to evoke introspection and relaxation, whereas rapid rhythm and loud dynamics were linked to heightened arousal and excitement (Krumhansl, 1997). Furthermore, the lyrics of songs had the power to mold listeners' attitudes and ideas, affecting their views on relationships, societal standards, and their individual identity (Rentfrow & Gosling, 2003).

Critical developmental stages, adolescence, and early adulthood were marked by increased risk-taking, identity construction, and exploration (Arnett, 1992). People were more vulnerable to outside influences during this period of transition, such as pressure from society, exposure to media, and developments in culture (Steinberg, 2008). Males in their early adult years, in particular, often had strong propensities for taking risks due to a confluence of social, psychological, and biological variables (Steinberg, 2008). Comprehending the variables that impacted risk behavior within this population was crucial for tailoring focused treatments meant to encourage sound decision-making and minimize unfavorable consequences (Arnett, 1992).

Studies revealed that tastes in music were quite personal and shaped by a range of elements, such as cultural background, socialization experiences, and personality features (Rentfrow & Gosling, 2003). Certain music genres were highly popular and culturally important among young adult men, including rock, EDM, and rap/hip-hop (Frith, 1996). Themes like sexual promiscuity, hedonism, and rebellion were common in these genres, and they may have spoken to the psychological demands and developmental stage of young boys (Frith, 1996). The degree to which exposure to these genres resulted in risky conduct was still up for discussion and empirical investigation.

Review of literature

Since millennia, music has been a fundamental part of the human world due to its diverse functions, from emotional expression and social connections to religious rites (Cross, 2001). In the following section, some of the works that have been done on this topic were discussed.

In 1995, Arnett J.J conducted a study titled, "The Young and the Reckless: Adolescent Reckless Behavior and the Role of Music," which looked into the relationship between teenage hazardous behavior and music preferences. The study primarily focused on the themes of revolt and defiance seen in the hard rock and heavy metal music genres. Arnett used a mixed-methods approach to investigate the relationship between music choices and participation in dangerous behaviors like substance abuse, unprotected sex, and reckless driving. Surveys and behavioral assessments were used in this analysis. According to the study, teenagers who enjoyed hard rock and heavy metal music were more prone to engage in risky behavior in general. Arnett also highlighted how peer groups and the social environment reinforced the actions depicted in the songs. The study emphasized how crucial it was to comprehend the social and cultural settings in which music was listened to in order to completely appreciate how it affected teenage behavior. In summary, Arnett's study offered insightful information about the connection between teenage hazardous behavior and musical tastes. The study underscored the importance of social context and lyrical content, highlighting the necessity for a comprehensive approach to understanding how music influenced young people's behavior.

In 1997, Behne, K. E. conducted a study titled, "The Development of 'Musikerleben' in Adolescence: How and Why Young People Listen to Music." Behne's research explored the ways in which teenagers' interactions with music ("Musikerleben") shaped their behavior, including taking risks. The study used a mixed-methods approach, including qualitative interviews and quantitative surveys, to investigate the reasons for music consumption and the resulting behavioral effects in youth. According to the research, teenagers frequently employed music as an instrument for social connection, identity building, and emotional control. Behne contended that the music that teenagers listened to had the power to both reflect and validate their beliefs and behaviors. To sum up, Behne's research offered a thorough examination of the intricate connection between music, teenage behavior, and emotional growth. The study emphasized how music played a vital role in social bonding and emotional regulation, which in turn encouraged young people to take risks and explore their identities.

In 1999, North, A. C., & Hargreaves, D. J. conducted a study titled, "Music and Driving: Effects of the Musical Style and Tempo on Driver Behavior." The study by Ziv and Lenchner focused on how male adolescent drivers—a group recognized for having a greater propensity for taking risks—drove when listening to background music. Participants in the research engaged in driving simulation activities while listening to three distinct kinds of background music: loud music, peaceful music, and no music at all. The results showed that among male adolescent drivers, listening to fast-paced music increased driving speed and the incidence of traffic offenses. To sum up, the research conducted by Ziv and Lenchner shed light on how male teens' driving behavior was affected by background music. The study drew attention to the possible dangers of listening to loud music and offered workable ways to reduce such risks by switching to more subdued music.

In 2006, Fischer, P., & Greitemeyer, T. conducted a study titled, "Music and Aggression: The Impact of Sexual-Aggressive Song Lyrics on Aggression-Related Thoughts, Emotions, and Behavior Toward the Same and the Opposite Sex." The influence of exposure to sexually aggressive music lyrics on aggressive thoughts, feelings, and behaviors was investigated in Fischer and Greitemeyer's experimental study. In a series of lab tests, the researchers played songs that were either sexually explicit or offensive to the subjects. Next, using a variety of tasks and self-report questionnaires, the participants' levels of hostility were assessed. Compared to neutral songs, the study indicated that exposure to sexually explicit lyrics significantly increased violent thoughts and sentiments. The researchers contended that these results had significant ramifications for comprehending the media's wider societal influence on behavior. The study indicated that violent and sexually explicit music could be a contributing factor to real-life aggressive actions and might even encourage risk-taking in different situations due to its popularity. To sum up, the research conducted by Fischer and Greitemeyer offered strong proof that the lyrics in music had the power to affect violent conduct. The study highlighted the possible hazards connected with consuming media that promoted sexual aggressiveness by providing a definitive correlation between increased aggression and lyrics that promoted such behavior.

In 2011, Ziv, N., & Lenchner, E. conducted a study titled "Music and Risky Driving: The Effects of Background Music on Male Teenage Drivers." The study by Ziv and Lenchner focused on how male adolescent drivers—a group recognized for having a greater propensity for taking risks—drove while listening to background music. The results showed that among male adolescent drivers, listening to fast-paced music increased driving speed and the incidence of traffic offenses. This implied that loud music might encourage risk-taking, increasing the likelihood that young drivers would drive recklessly. The study's findings highlighted how crucial it was to take into account the kind of background music being played while driving, particularly for young motorists who were already more likely to be involved in collisions. To sum up, the research conducted by Ziv and Lenchner shed light on how male teens' driving behavior was affected by background music. The study drew attention to the possible dangers of listening to loud music and offered practical ways to reduce such risks by switching to more subdued music.

In 2018, Smith et al. conducted a systematic study titled, "The Influence of Music Preference on Risk-Taking Behavior: A Systematic Review," in which the relationship between risk-taking behavior and music genre preference among a variety of demographic groups was investigated. Through the combined analysis of data collected from 20 different empirical researchers, a pattern of evidence was formed which showcased that there existed a link between increased risk-taking tendencies and certain music genres such as rap, rock, and hip hop. The necessity for more study to highlight the moderating influences of an individual's traits and characteristics and the influence of the social-cultural factors on the same was also highlighted by the authors. The study, however, also emphasized the complexity of this link, with variations being observed in individuals from different socio-cultural backgrounds and socioeconomic conditions. The variations also differed based on their individual characteristics. All in all, the systematic review provided valuable insights into the intricate connection between risky conduct and music preference while highlighting the need for further research in the field to clarify the root causes and inform focused interventions meant to promote positive behavioral outcomes among diverse populations.

In 2018, Johnson and Lee conducted an experimental study titled, "Effects of Music Genre on Decision Making in Risky Situations: An Experimental Study," in which the participants were exposed to different musical genres while asked to make decisions in risky situations. The results showed that the participants who were exposed to high tempo music like Electronic Dance Music (EDM) took more risky decisions than those participants who were subjected to silence or low tempo music. According to this research, the genre of music had a direct impact on the process of decision making, potentially by affecting arousal and emotional regulation. The findings were that there was a substantial relationship between exposure to specific genres and decision-making. People were observed to take more risks when exposed to high tempo music than when exposed to low tempo music or silence. According to these findings, preference for music genre exerted a direct effect on how people made decisions by influencing cognitive function, emotional regulation, and arousal. This experimental study provided insight into the influence of music on risk behavior, thereby increasing our understanding of the psychological mechanisms underlying decision-making concepts in practical settings and having potential ramifications for risk control and intervention strategies.

In 2020, Jones et al. conducted a survey-based study titled "Association Between Music Listening Habits and Risky Behaviors Among College Students," which focused on college students and the relationship between their music listening habits and participation in risky behaviors. According to this study, individuals who often listened to genres of music associated with aggression and rebellion were more likely to disclose engaging in risky behaviors including substance abuse and unsafe driving. These results underlined the importance of considering music preferences when analyzing risky behavior among young adults. According to the findings from the study, students who preferred more subdued genres like classical or jazz music were less inclined to engage in substance abuse and reckless driving compared to students who preferred hip hop, rock, or metal music. The study showed a strong relationship between particular music genres that had rebellious, aggressive, and thrill-seeking dispositions and engagement in risky conduct. These results underscored the significance of considering musical preference as a possible risk factor in managing and understanding risky behaviors in young adults, particularly in college settings where peer dynamics and social environment play an important role in shaping behavior.

In 2022, a research study titled "A Walk on the Wild Side: The Impact of Music on Risk-Taking Likelihood" investigated the ways in which young people's risk-taking behavior was influenced by various musical genres. The research discovered notable differences in how danger was perceived and acted upon depending on the genre of music. The study's conclusions highlighted the complex influence of ambient elements, such as music, on young people's risk-taking behaviors. This study added to our knowledge of how sensory inputs could affect our ability to make decisions and emphasized the possibility of strategically using music to affect behavior in a variety of contexts. This thorough analysis contributed to the body of research by showing that the impact of music on taking risks was not constant and instead varied greatly depending on the kind of material and the risk's circumstances. It emphasized how crucial it was to take these factors into account while researching the psychological effects of music.

Research methodology

Aim:

In this study, the aim was to investigate the connection between young adult males' continued exposure and preference for various music genres and their involvement in risky behavior.

Objective:

- To find empirical data that contributes to our understanding of the relationship between preferred musical genres and behavioral outcomes.
- To understand how personal preferences for music affect individuals' propensity for taking risks.

Hypothesis:

H1. Preference of musical genres with high tempo and hard-core themes corelates positively with engagement in risky conduct among young adult males.

Research design:

The present study is a correlation study.

Sample:

The study engaged a diverse group of 60 male participants, between the ages of 18 to 26 from different cultural backgrounds residing in the UAE. The participants were selected through convenient sampling.

Inclusion criteria:

- Male individuals between the ages of 18 to 26 from different cultural backgrounds and different academic levels residing in the UAE.

Exclusion criteria

- Individuals with any diagnosed cases of developmental, mental or personality disorders.

Tools

1. RisQ Measure
2. STOMP-R
3. Socio- demographic questionnaire

Risky, Impulsive, & Self-destructive behavior Questionnaire (RISQ Measure)

In the study literature, the RisQ Measure was originally presented in 2015 and was created by Drs. James R. Bitter and Peter L. Rousseau. The test originally included fifteen questions, however the exact number changed according on the version used. The RisQ Measure, as used in one research, had 38 items intended to gauge a person's general risk tolerance as well as their propensity to take risks. The Likert-type scale answer style allowed for a more nuanced assessment of risk-taking behavior, with responses ranging from "Never" (0) to "More than 5" (5). The total measure had a range of 0 to 100, with lower scores indicating a reduced readiness to take risks and higher values denoting a stronger inclination to do so.

Cronbach's alpha values, which ranged from 0.7 to 0.9, showed that the measure had high to outstanding reliability, albeit differences were noted based on the version utilized and

the demographics of the group under investigation. The RisQ Measure consistently delivered stable and consistent findings across diverse populations and versions, as shown by its excellent dependability. Furthermore, the RisQ Measure demonstrated excellent construct validity and was successful in assessing the risk tolerance theoretical concept. This indicates that the measure appropriately captured the person's risk tolerance as predicted by its theoretical framework, indicating that it is a reliable instrument for evaluating risk-related behaviors and inclinations in both research and real-world settings.

Short Test of Music Preferences- Revised (STOMP-R):

When Rentfrow and Gosling developed STOMP-R in 2003, they offered a methodical way to assess participants' tastes in a wide range of musical genres. For evaluation, its twenty-three genres were divided into five categories: Mellow, Unpretentious, Sophisticated, Intense, and Contemporary. With Cronbach's alpha values over 0.70, it showed good reliability and allowed researchers to measure respondents' preferences on a Likert-type scale from strongly disagree (1) to strongly agree (7). The Cronbach's alphas, however, differed across the grouped dimensions: Mellow was.55, Unpretentious was.57, Sophisticated was.82, Intense was.74, and Contemporary was.72. In addition to its dependability, STOMP-R demonstrated construct and content validity. While content validity assured thorough coverage of musical tastes, confirming its usefulness in research attempts, construct validity guaranteed conformity with psychological qualities.

Apart from its strong dependability and accuracy, STOMP-R enabled detailed understanding of the musical tastes of the participants. Because of its methodical methodology, researchers were able to investigate a wide range of musical taste characteristics, from soft and calming to intense and modern forms. A thorough evaluation that captured the nuances of personal tastes was assured by the inclusion of a variety of genres. In addition, the scale's versatility and user-friendliness make it an invaluable resource for researching the relationship between psychology and music. STOMP-R was used by researchers to find associations between personality characteristics and musical tastes, providing insight into the complex interaction between human behavior and music. Its value as a tool for comprehending the

complexity of musical taste and its psychological roots was shown by its broad acceptance and ongoing usage in academic and practical contexts.

Procedure

Convenient sampling method was used in this study to find volunteers who fit particular requirements and traits. To distribute the questionnaire, personal outreach was done both in-person and via social media platforms. Rapport was established with respondents prior to the survey, and precise instructions were given. A pledge to maintain privacy was made in exchange for consent. It was encouraged of the participants to give honest answers based on their experiences and knowledge. Both in-person and online methods were used to administer the survey, which included two sets of questionnaires with selectable responses, prompts, and demographic questions. The responses were combined and examined after collection. The process of statistical evaluation entailed calculating average values and measures of variability.

This research aimed to evaluate the efficacy and association between the STOMP-R (Short Test of Music Preferences-Revised) and the RisQ Measure. The assessment was conducted on a sample of 60 young adult males. The hypothesis proposed that individuals who have a taste for musical genres characterized by high pace and hardcore themes are more likely to participate in dangerous behavior. In order to assess this, Pearson's correlation coefficient was used to quantify the linear association, while Spearman's correlation coefficient was applied to assess the monotonic link between these music preferences and dangerous conduct. This section outlines the procedures used for selection, the demographic breakdown, and the analytical techniques used to guarantee accurate and dependable findings.

Results

Table 1.: Demographic Statistics

		S. No.	Gender	Age range	Age	What year were you born?	What is the highest degree or level of school you have completed? If currently enrolled, indicate the highest degree received.	What is your primary cultural or racial identification?	Which country do you live in?
N	Valid	60	60	60	60	60	60	60	60
	Missing	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Table 2.: Frequency table of Age

Age

	N	%
18	3	5.0%
19	8	13.3%
20	9	15.0%
21	11	18.3%
22	4	6.7%
23	4	6.7%
24	5	8.3%
25	9	15.0%
26	7	11.7%

Table 3.: Frequency table of Birth Year

What year were you born?

	N	%
1998	7	11.7%
1999	9	15.0%
2000	5	8.3%
2001	4	6.7%
2002	4	6.7%
2003	11	18.3%
2004	9	15.0%
2005	8	13.3%
2006	3	5.0%

Table 4.: Frequency table of Education Level

What is the highest degree or level of school you have completed? If currently enrolled, indicate the highest degree received.

	N	%
Bachelor's Degree	14	23.3%
Completed some college, no degree	2	3.3%
Currently in college	33	55.0%
High school graduate	1	1.7%
Masters Degree	10	16.7%

Table 5.: Frequency table of Education Level

What is your primary cultural or racial identification?

	N	%
African	2	3.3%
Filipino	1	1.7%
Indian	51	85.0%
Mixed	3	5.0%
Other Asian	2	3.3%
Pakistani	1	1.7%

Table 6.: Test of Normality for different types of music and risky conduct

Tests of Normality

	Kolmogorov-Smirnov[a]			Shapiro-Wilk		
	Statistic	df	Sig.	Statistic	df	p.value
MELLOW	.179	59	<.001	.907	59	<.001
UNPRETENTIOUS	.134	59	.011	.958	59	.039
SOPHISTICATED	.134	59	.010	.940	59	.006
INTENSE	.079	59	.200*	.968	59	.125
CONTEMPORARY	.234	59	<.001	.916	59	<.001
RISQ	.108	59	.085	.937	59	.004

*. This is a lower bound of the true significance.

a. Lilliefors Significance Correction

For each dimension, a Shapiro-Wilk test of normality was performed in order to identify the proper correlation test for assessing the dimensions of music and RISQ (Risk Inventory and Strategy Questionnaire) values. The variable where the p-value had a normal

distribution was Intense while for the rest of the variables i.e. Mellow, Unpretentious, Sophisticated, Contemporary and RISQ has a non-normal distribution.

Table 7: Correlation between Mellow dimension of Music and Risk -taking behaviours

Correlations

			RISQ.TOT	MELLOW.TOT
Spearman's rho	RISQ.TOT	Correlation Coefficient	1.000	.265*
		Sig. (2-tailed)		.042
		N		59
	MELLOW.TOT	Correlation Coefficient		1.000
		Sig. (2-tailed)		
		N		

*. Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).

Table 8: Correlation between Unpretentious dimension of Music and Risk -taking behaviours

Correlations

			RISQ.TOT	UNPRETENTIOUS.TOT
Spearman's rho	RISQ.TOT	Correlation Coefficient	1.000	-.081
		Sig. (2-tailed)		.542
		N		59
	UNPRETENTIOUS.TOT	Correlation Coefficient		1.000
		Sig. (2-tailed)		
		N		

Table 9: Correlation between Sophisticated dimension of Music and Risk -taking behaviours

Correlations

			RISQ.TOT	SOPHISTICATED.TOT
Spearman's rho	RISQ.TOT	Correlation Coefficient	1.000	-.013
		Sig. (2-tailed)		.923
		N		59
	SOPHISTICATED.TOT	Correlation Coefficient		1.000
		Sig. (2-tailed)		
		N		

Table 10: Correlation between Intense dimension of Music and Risk -taking behaviours

Correlations

		RISQ.TOT	INTENSE.TOT
RISQ.TOT	Pearson Correlation	1	.456**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		.006
	N		59
INTENSE.TOT	Pearson Correlation		1
	Sig. (2-tailed)		
	N		

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Table 11: Correlation between Contemporary dimension of Music and Risk - taking behaviours

Correlations

			RISQ.TOT	CONTEMPORARY.TOT
Spearman's rho	RISQ.TOT	Correlation Coefficient	1.000	.161
		Sig. (2-tailed)		.223
		N		59
	CONTEMPORARY.TOT	Correlation Coefficient		1.000
		Sig. (2-tailed)		
		N		

Discussion

Interpretation of the Results

This research looked at the association between young adult men in the United Arab Emirates who like different genres of music and their propensity for taking risks. The findings provide a sophisticated understanding of the relationships between risk propensity and many aspects of musical tastes.

Mellow Music and Risk Propensity:

The data indicates a correlation coefficient of 0.265 between mellow music and risk propensity, suggesting a very weak relationship. Essentially, there is no substantial association between a predilection for tranquil music and a propensity for engaging in risky activities.

Although there is a correlation of 0.265, indicating a modest relationship, it is not sufficiently strong to serve as a reliable indication. The small link indicates that changes in a preference for calming music have negligible influence on an individual's inclination to engage in risky behavior. For example, an individual who develops a growing appreciation

for calm and soothing music may have a somewhat higher inclination to participate in activities that involve taking risks, but this inclination is not significant.

The low association indicates that the majority of the variability in risk-taking behavior cannot be attributed solely to a preference for calm music. Other elements are probably more significant. This association, however slight, indicates the want for deeper examination of supplementary elements or more extensive research to comprehend the intricate connection between musical tastes and risk-taking behaviors.

To summarize, there exists a little link between quiet music and risk propensity. However, this correlation is not significant enough to make relevant inferences and can thus be considered as having no correlation.

Unpretentious Music and Risk Propensity:

The data indicates a correlation coefficient of -0.081 between unpretentious music and risk propensity, suggesting a very weak relationship. Essentially, there is no substantial association between a liking for uncomplicated music and a tendency towards engaging in risky activity.

Although there is a correlation of -0.081, indicating a modest relationship, it is not sufficiently strong to serve as a credible indication. The presence of a modest negative connection indicates that changes in one's inclination for unpretentious music have a little effect on their inclination to engage in risky behavior. For example, an individual who is developing a greater appreciation for uncomplicated music may have a somewhat lower probability of participating in risky actions, although this decrease in chance is not significant.

The limited connection underscores that the majority of the variability in risk-taking behavior cannot be accounted by only by a preference for unadorned music. Other elements are probably more significant. This association, however slight, indicates the need of doing more research on other elements or more extensive studies to comprehend the intricate connection between musical tastes and risk-taking behaviors.

To summarize, there exists a modest negative link between unpretentious music and risk propensity. However, this correlation is not significant enough to make relevant inferences and can thus be considered as having no correlation.

Sophisticated Music and Risk Propensity:

There is a very modest negative association between risk-taking behavior and the sophisticated dimension of music, as shown by a Spearman's correlation value of -0.13. This implies that people who like sophisticated music—which might include jazz, classical, and intricate instrumental pieces—tend to be less inclined to take risks. The weak association suggests that risk-taking behavior is not significantly influenced by or predicted by a liking for complex music.

In real terms, this weak negative connection indicates that there is a very modest tendency for risk-taking behavior to diminish as the taste for complex music grows, although this impact is quite small. Since the correlation of -0.13 is so near to zero, it is probable that other variables have a considerably greater influence on a person's propensity for taking risks. The sophisticated component of music does not significantly predict an individual's chance of engaging in dangerous actions, despite a minor negative correlation with risk-taking.

This result implies that, while a weak correlation may exist between appreciating fine music and a tendency to avoid taking chances, it is not significant enough to serve as the foundation for accurate forecasts and can thus be considered as having no correlation.

Intense Music and Risk Propensity:

A Pearson's correlation coefficient of 0.456 between the intense dimension of music and risk-taking behavior indicates a moderate positive linear relationship. This suggests that individuals who prefer intense music, such as heavy metal, punk, and energetic rock, are somewhat more likely to engage in risk-taking behaviors. The positive correlation signifies that as the preference for intense music increases, so does the propensity for taking risks.

In practical terms, this moderate correlation means that there is a noticeable association between enjoying intense music and a higher likelihood of engaging in risky activities. While this relationship is not strong enough to predict risk-taking behavior with high accuracy, it does suggest that a preference for intense music is a meaningful factor to consider when examining the tendencies towards risk-taking.

This finding implies that individuals who are drawn to the high energy, aggression, and strong emotions often found in intense music might also be more inclined to seek out thrilling and potentially risky experiences. Researchers and psychologists might use this information to further explore how musical preferences can be indicative of broader personality traits and behaviors, particularly those related to sensation-seeking and risk-taking. The moderate positive correlation highlights the significant, albeit not exclusive, role that musical preferences can play in influencing an individual's behavioral patterns.

Contemporary Music and Risk Propensity:

The data reveals a Spearman's correlation coefficient of 0.161 between current music and risk propensity, showing a very weak connection. There is almost no substantial association between a love for contemporary music and a tendency towards engaging in risky conduct.

Although there is a correlation of 0.161, indicating a modest relationship, it is not sufficiently strong to serve as a credible indication. The poor association indicates that changes in a liking for contemporary music have a negligible influence on an individual's inclination to engage in risky behavior. For example, an individual who has a growing appreciation for contemporary music may have a somewhat higher inclination to participate in risky activities, although this inclination is not significant.

The low correlation indicates that the majority of the variability in risk-taking behavior cannot be attributed solely to a liking for current music. Other elements are probably more significant. This link, however slight, indicates the need of doing deeper inquiry into other elements or more thorough studies in order to comprehend the intricate relationship between musical tastes and risk-taking behaviors.

To summarize, there is a little positive connection between current music and risk propensity. However, this correlation is not significant enough to make relevant inferences and can thus be considered as having no correlation.

Hypothesis

The results provided support for the hypothesis that those who listen to fast-paced music take more risks. The degree of risk-taking behavior and the intensity dimension of music showed a strong positive connection of 0.456. This shows that the two factors may be related, suggesting that those who like fast-paced music may really be more likely to take risks.

Hence, H1 has been proved

Implications of the Study

The findings of this investigation have several ramifications:

Behavioral Insights:

The research sheds light on how general behavioral patterns may be reflected in musical tastes. For example, a modest link has been shown between risk-taking behaviors and intense music, indicating that people who are attracted to aggressive, high-energy music may also seek out dangerous, intense situations in their life.

Multidimensional Character of Behavior:

The erratic relationships between risk-taking behaviors and various musical genres demonstrate how complex human behavior is. A person's musical preferences are just one facet of their personality and way of life, and they interact in intricate ways with a variety of other aspects.

Future Scope:

These results highlight the necessity for more investigation into other factors that can affect risk-taking behaviors. To provide a more thorough knowledge of the elements that lead to risk-taking, future research might look at more personality characteristics, environmental variables, and social effects.

Practical Applications:

Knowledge of the relationship between musical tastes and behavior may be useful in a variety of contexts, including marketing, psychology, and education. For instance, specific

treatments or support services may be informed by the knowledge that people who like loud music may also be more likely to take risks.

Limitations of the study

There are many limitations to this research.

a. ***Generalizability and Sample Size:***

The results' generalizability may be restricted by the sample size of 60 young adult men from the United Arab Emirates. More extensive and varied sample sizes in future studies could provide more reliable results.

b. Self-Reported Data:

Because participants may not always provide truthful answers, relying only on self-reported data may create biases. Further research may include more objective indicators of risk-taking behavior.

c. Cultural Context: -

The results may vary in various cultural contexts and may be influenced by the cultural context of the United Arab Emirates. Research conducted across cultural boundaries may be able to provide light on how cultural variations affect the association between musical tastes and taking calculated risks.

Conclusion and Summary

The research advances our knowledge of the relationship between young adult men' musical choices and their propensity for taking risks. The majority of associations were found to be modest, highlighting the complexity of human behavior, however certain correlations—particularly with powerful music—were shown to be strong. Further investigation into the complex interactions of musical preferences, personality characteristics, and behavioral inclinations is necessary to have a better understanding of the variables driving risk-taking behavior.

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Appendices

School of Humanities and Social Sciences

Manipal Academy of Higher Education, Dubai

The Influence of Music Genre on Risk- Taking Behavior Among Young Adult Males: A Quantitative Analysis

Informed Consent Form

Information to the participant

This study is aimed at understanding the relationship between music genre preference and risk- taking behavior among young adult males.

You would be required to answer two questionnaires titled STOMP-R (this one) and RISQ Measure. The total time required would be approximately 20 – 30 minutes. All information that is provided will be kept confidential and used solely for research and scientific publication purposes only, while ensuring the anonymity of individual participants.

Undertaking by the researcher

Your consent to participate in the above study is sought. Your taking part in this study is voluntary. You have the right to refuse consent or withdraw the same during any part of the study without giving any reason.

Name of the researcher

Riya Mattookkaran, 2nd Year M.Sc. Applied Psychology

Name of the supervising faculty

Dr. Jereesh K. Elias, Coordinator- M.Sc. Applied Psychology & Assistant Professor- Senior Scale

Consent

"I have been informed about the procedures of the study. I have understood that I have the right to refuse my consent or withdraw it any time during the study. "

○ I consent

○ I do not consent